

The 6:15

SUNDAY · AUGUST 9, 2026

NO. 1

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Mon Aug 10	Earnings: Nebius (NBIS), AST SpaceMobile (ASTS), CoreWeave (CRWV), Lumentum (LITE)
Tue Aug 11	CT primary; 3-yr note auction, \$58B; earnings: Super Micro (SMCI)
Wed Aug 12	July CPI, 8:30am; 10-yr note auction, \$42B; earnings: Cisco (aft. close)
Thu Aug 13	July PPI, 8:30am; jobless claims, 8:30am; 30-yr bond auction, \$25B; earnings: Applied Materials
Mon Aug 17	Settlement, Aug quarterly refunding (3/10/30-yr)
Tue Aug 18	FL and AK primaries

FOMC (Sept 15–16) falls outside the 10-day window. Fri Aug 14 calendar carries nothing verified this run.

METRICS · FRIDAY CASH CLOSE, AUG 7, UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI / spread	\$82.04 (-1.74%) / \$78.20 (+~1%) / \$3.84
10y / 2y UST	4.68% Fri · 2y 4.18% as of Aug 5, not re-verified
DXY	99.56 (-0.37%), 7-week low
S&P 500 / Nasdaq Comp.	7,757.64 (+0.62%, record) / 26,690.62 (+1.30%)
VIX / Gold	16.50 / \$4,352.53 (+2.63%), 2-mo high
Asia / Europe closes	Nikkei -0.73% · HSI 25,668 (+0.54%) · Shanghai 3,940 (+1.02%) · FTSE 10,901 (+0.31%) · DAX 26,319 (+0.69%)
Retail gas (AAA natl.)	\$4.01/gal, Aug 9

No new settle since Friday — markets shut through the weekend; futures reopen 6pm ET Sunday, after this issue's press time. Nikkei level not independently confirmed this run, % change only.

HORMUZ COUNTERS — DAY 162 OF CLOSURE

PortWatch transits	2 on Aug 2 vs. 73/day baseline (IMF/AIS; weekly, publishes Tue — lagged)
Kpler transits	5 in 24h to Aug 5 (3 in, 2 out) vs. >20/day pre-crisis
Kpler dark-AIS share	41% of 106 crossings Jul 27–Aug 2; 62% of 102 since Jul 14 blockade
War-risk premia	~30x pre-crisis per CNN (Aug 8); Lloyd's List: "mid-single-digit%" of hull value, new normal (Jul)
Strait-specific strikes, 24h	None confirmed this run (not verified)

PortWatch counts all AIS-tracked transits against a 73/day baseline; Kpler's >20/day baseline covers tankers only — the two are not directly comparable and are reported side by side, never netted. Neither vendor has published a running strike tally; treat the 24h line as unconfirmed, not zero.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	No front-office moves in the last 24 hours
Knicks	No reported moves; Towns extension-eligible Aug 12
Northwestern	No reported moves; opens Sept 5 vs. South Dakota State

LEAD

IRAN WAR — DAY 162

Houthis hit an Aramco refinery as Washington says a Hormuz deal is close

[NEW] Yemen's Houthis struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery with a drone before dawn Gulf time Sunday, touching off a fire that was extinguished with no injuries reported at the 400,000 b/d plant, per Aramco and Saudi state media. Hours earlier and separately, a Houthi strike on the Red Sea port of Mokha in Yemen killed at least seven people. The Houthis say both were retaliation for Saudi strikes on Saada and Hajjah provinces; Riyadh denies besieging the group, which declared a naval blockade against Saudi shipping in the Red Sea last month. Neither attack was on the Strait of Hormuz itself — they widen the war's second front, Bab el-Mandeb and the Red Sea

approaches, which now carries its own war-risk pricing separate from the Gulf.

The mechanism that matters for barrels: Treasury Secretary Bessent told CNBC Sunday there is "a chance we may have a deal today or tomorrow" to reopen the Strait, which has been closed to normal commercial traffic since the US and Israel opened the air war on Iran February 28 and killed its supreme leader. Iran's own messaging undercuts the optimism — Tehran's national security apparatus says traffic won't normalize without a US troop withdrawal, an end to the war, and compensation, and Iran is separately negotiating a per-transit toll with Oman that the White House has called a redline. IRGC statements Saturday tied reopening explicitly to US concessions, not the Oman track. That gap — Washington signaling imminence, Tehran denying formal talks are even underway — has repeated for at least a week (Aug 2 through Aug 8 CNN live coverage) without a signed text.

Read: the Houthi escalation is best understood as pressure, not a separate war. Widening the Red Sea front raises the cost of any outcome short of a deal favorable to Iran's camp, and it complicates the insurance math just as Hormuz talk turns constructive — Lloyd's List's own reporting shows Gulf war-risk premiums have been sticky near their post-February highs even during the most optimistic negotiating windows. CNN's Sunday figure of insurance pricing near 30 times pre-crisis levels, if it holds, argues against reading the Bessent line as a market signal to front-run; carriers are not repricing risk down yet. Brent's Friday session (-1.74% to \$82.04) came before the refinery strike and reflected the softer US labor data more than Gulf risk — a genuine settle incorporating Sunday's attack and

the Bessent comments won't print until Monday, and that Monday open is the number to watch, not anything traded over the weekend.

Second-order: gold's push to a two-month high (\$4,352.53, +2.63% Friday) and the dollar's slide to a seven-week low were driven primarily by Friday's payroll shock, but a stalled or reversed Hormuz reopening would layer safe-haven and inflation-hedge demand on top of that dovish-Fed trade — precisely the kind of cross-current CPI on Wednesday will have to be read against.

POLITICS

[DEVELOPING] The Senate passed a bipartisan continuing resolution Saturday funding the government through December 11, brokered by Appropriations leaders Susan Collins and Patty Murray, averting a shutdown before the chamber's August recess. The House, which passed its own CR through December 4 and has already left for recess, must reconcile the gap when it returns in early September — leaving the funding fight unresolved, not closed, into the fall. Connecticut holds a primary Tuesday; Florida and Alaska follow August 18, part of the run-up to the November 3 midterms.

ECONOMICS

Friday's July jobs report is still the operative data point: payrolls fell 23,000 against consensus estimates in the 83,000–95,000 range, and the BLS cut May and June's combined gains by a further 103,000. Unemployment ticked down to 4.1% from 4.2%, a composition effect of falling participation rather than hiring strength — losses concentrated in local government education (-50,000) and retail (-19,000). The soft print is why futures markets moved to price higher odds of Fed easing and why gold and duration both rallied

Friday. Wednesday's CPI print (Aug 12) is the next test of whether the Fed can act on that weakness without an inflation offset from the Hormuz-driven energy complex.

BUSINESS

[NEW] Amazon CEO Andy Jassy-adjacent reporting has the company committing roughly \$200 billion to AI infrastructure this year, with Jeff Bezos framing it as defining the company's next decade — the clearest signal yet that hyperscaler capex guidance for 2026 is still climbing, not plateauing. AMD's Q2 revenue rose 50% year-over-year to \$11.5 billion on data-center demand more than doubling; Astera Labs posted \$392.4 million in Q2 revenue, up 104%, on AI-connectivity demand. Hut 8 shares jumped on new infrastructure agreements with Anthropic and Fluidstack. Away from tech: Burger King has overtaken Wendy's as the second-largest US burger chain by unit count.

TECHNOLOGY

Tesla and SpaceX are building a joint chip-fabrication complex — "Terafab" — in Grimes County, Texas, with an initial \$16.8 billion outlay to supply silicon for Tesla vehicles, Optimus, and SpaceX compute. Anthropic is reportedly assembling an internal silicon team to design custom chips for Claude, a step toward owning more of its inference stack rather than relying solely on merchant GPU supply. Samsung and SK Hynix both disclosed new memory architectures aimed at the AI bandwidth bottleneck — Samsung's "zHBM" vertical stacking and new high-bandwidth flash standards from both firms. Astera Labs' Scorpio switch line is the connectivity layer cited across several of this quarter's AI-infrastructure earnings beats.

GEOPOLITICS

[NEW] Saudi Arabia, Turkey and Pakistan signed the Mecca Joint Defence Agreement August 7 — a mutual-defense pact under which an attack on one is treated as an attack on all three, signed by Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, President Erdogan and PM Shehbaz Sharif. It extends the bilateral Saudi-Pakistan pact from September 2025 to include Turkey, explicitly in response to repeated missile and drone attacks on Gulf states since February. The combination — NATO's second-largest military, the top oil exporter, and a nuclear-armed state — is a materially new regional deterrence structure, not a symbolic gesture. Separately, Lebanon's government and a south Lebanon mayor allege Israeli troops entered Zawtar al-Gharbiya, a village handed to the Lebanese army in July under the US-sponsored "pilot zone" framework, and built an earthen barrier blocking a road; the IDF said it was unaware of the incident. Roughly 50 displaced families had returned to the village since the July 21 handover.

IRAN & HORMUZ

[DEVELOPING] Beyond the Lead's mechanics: the negotiating track running through Oman is distinct from — and, per Iran's IRGC, subordinate to — direct US-Iran messaging passed through intermediaries including Qatar and Pakistan. Iran has publicly declined to characterize the exchanges as negotiations at all even as Trump calls this round a "last chance." The toll Iran wants to levy on ships transiting via the Oman arrangement remains the specific sticking point the White House has rejected. On the water, the vendor divergence is worth sitting with: PortWatch's 2-per-day figure and Kpler's 5-in-24-hours figure aren't reconcilable into one

number because they track different universes (all AIS transits vs. tanker-specific movement) on different lag schedules — both point the same direction, a throughput collapse of 90%+ versus pre-crisis norms, but neither should be quoted as "the" transit count. The dark-AIS share (62% since the July 14 blockade) is itself a lower bound, since it only captures vessels Kpler can still infer routing for through secondary signals.

SPORTS

Yankees	Beat Braves 5-4 Aug 8, Cole over Sale.
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Knicks	Offseason; no game.
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Northwestern	Preseason camp; no game.
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Continuity. First issue — no prior edition to compare against. Baseline established for Hormuz counters, Board metrics, and the Mecca pact for future issues to track against.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory. Compiled from 23 sourced retrievals; press time 5:09pm ET Sunday, Aug 9, 2026 — before Sunday evening futures reopen, so overnight equity-index futures moves are not yet knowable and are omitted rather than guessed.